MCP
Mushroom Cloud Press
Speech Scripts

Title:
Playdate

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PLAYDATE

CAST OF CHARACTERS

2 (1M, 1F)

CASSIE (F)	A 4-year-old girl, played by someone older than that
BENJAMIN (M)	A 4-year-old boy, played by someone older than that

CHARACTERS

These characters can be played by actors of nearly any age (ranging from middle school to adult), but they are actually 4-year-old children playing grown-ups… at least at first. When the dialog indicates CASSIE (ADULT) and BENJAMIN (ADULT), the actors are portraying a child's skewed image of how an adult behaves. When the dialog simply indicates CASSIE and BENJAMIN, the actors portray 4-year-olds talking to each other as children (during which the actors try to encapsulate the innocence and arrogance of the very young).

DIALOG

Many words throughout the script are intentionally misspelled in an attempt to capture how young children often (and adorably) mispronounce words. "Spaghetti" becomes "pa-sketti," "hospital" becomes "hop-spital," and so on. Some dialog is also written to make it sound as if they have slight speech impediments, as children learning to speak often do ("play" becomes "pway," "think" becomes "fink" or "sink," and so on), but this is less pronounced when they are pretending to be adults. You can also play with cadence; children often take breaths or pauses in unusual places, especially during long sentences.

SETTING

The living room of Cassie's home, although it could be a blank stage. Two chairs – possibly comically oversized chairs to make the actors look small – are optional. A table between the chairs, for the actors to share while coloring, is also optional.

PROPERTIES

- 2 coloring books (pre-set)
- Crayons (pre-set)
- A blanket, or long-sleeved sweater or jacket, for Benjamin (pre-set)
- A blanket, or long-sleeved sweater or jacket, for Cassie (pre-set)
- A briefcase (carried on by BENJAMIN)
- A comic book starring a female super-hero, such as Wonder Woman (carried on by CASSIE)

PREMIERE PRODUCTIONS

Playdate was first presented on June 9-11, 2017 as part of the 10-Minute Play Festival at Civic Theatre of Greater Lafayette in Lafayette, IN. Director: Lyle Janney. Producer: Steven Koehler. Cast: Abby McClure ("Cassie") and Chris Fulk ("Benjamin").

Playdate was next presented on October 12-15, 2017 as part of "Tall Guy, Short Stories: 10-Minute Plays by Scott Haan" at Clinton County Civic Theatre in Frankfort, IN. Director: Jean Warren. Assistant Director: Scott Haan. Cast: Kelsey Lukasik ("Cassie") and Griffin Hundley ("Benjamin").

PLAYDATE

(A family living room. At lights up, CASSIE is sitting or standing onstage, reading a comic book. After a pause, BENJAMIN enters SR with a briefcase.)

BENJAMIN (ADULT): Hey! I'm home from work. *(A beat as he drops his briefcase.)* Get me food.
CASSIE (ADULT): Did you just say "Get me food"? You can't order me around!
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Completely serious, baffled by her response.)* Yes, I can, because I'm the man, so you have to do what I say.
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Shocked.)* WHAT?!? Who told you THAT?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Proudly.)* My daddy. He used to say that all the time when he still lived with us, before mommy kicked him out.
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Fascinated by this.)* Whoa. *(Kicking.)* Did she really kick him, like with her foot?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Yep. And then mommy said, "Don't let the door hit you on the way out," but then she TRIED to hit him with the door anyway. That was confusing.
CASSIE (ADULT): Well, MY daddy says that men and women are the same.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): No they aren't… I saw a pitcher *(mispronouncing "picture")* once, and they have diff-int parts.
CASSIE (ADULT): I don't mean that. I mean daddy says men and women are EQUAL, and I'm not pa-spost *(mispronouncing "supposed")* to settle for someone who won't treat me right.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): I don't know about all that, but I know I'm still hungry, and you still didn't get me food yet.
CASSIE (ADULT): Ugh, for reals?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Yeah! I mean, I'm not picky. Just some pa-sketti-oh's would be fine.
CASSIE (ADULT): You can go get your OWN food. Your legs aren't broken… not yet, anyway.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): But I don't even know where the kitchen is.
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Pointing off SL.)* It's that way.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Doesn't move.)* Oh. Okay. *(Pause.)* You're SURE you don't want to get it for me?
CASSIE (ADULT): Very sure. I had a long day of working too, you know. I'm a aster-naut, and a vet-in-in-arian. What's your job?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Matter-of-fact.)* I'm Batman.
CASSIE (ADULT): You can't be Batman. That's not a job.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Okay, then I'm a Ninja Turtle. *(Launches into a karate move.)*
CASSIE (ADULT): That's not a job either. You're not playing this right.

(After a beat, a grumpy BENJAMIN sits down, either on the floor or on one of the chairs, and crosses his arms in defiance. He is now a 4-year-old boy. As kids, the characters can either sit or lie down on the ground, or if that makes them too low for the audience to see, they can sit in the chairs instead.)

BENJAMIN: *(Pouty.)* I don't fink I wanna play growed-up wif you any more.

(BENJAMIN grabs a coloring book and a crayon, and begins to color. After a few moments, CASSIE sits as well, now a 4-year-old girl. She puts down the comic book and picks up a coloring book instead. During the following dialog, they both color on and off.)

CASSIE: What's your name again?
BENJAMIN: Benjamin. What's your name?
CASSIE: Cassie. How old are you?
BENJAMIN: *(Holding up four fingers, making sure the audience can see them.)* This many. How old are you?
CASSIE: I'm four. I'll be five in Jan-uh-wary. I already told my daddy I want a puppy. A wittle baby puppy.
BENJAMIN: *(Proudly.)* I know where babies come from.
CASSIE: So do I.
BENJAMIN: I mean people babies, not puppy babies.
CASSIE: So do I.
BENJAMIN: Babies get brung by the spork.

CASSIE: What's a spork?
BENJAMIN: It's the bird that makes babies. You call the spork to come to your house, and you catch it, and then you kill it and eat it!
CASSIE: Eww, you eat it?
BENJAMIN: Yeah! And when you eat a whole spork, your tummy gets really big and fat, and it makes you hafta throw up, and when you do, a baby comes out of your mouth.
CASSIE: That's not what happens.
BENJAMIN: Yeah-huh!
CASSIE: No, it's not.
BENJAMIN: Is so! And only mommies can eat sporks, because if a daddy eats one, it's uh-legal and they hafs to go to jail.
CASSIE: No, babies come from a hops— a hop-spital. I saw it on da tee-bee. A mommy and a daddy go to there, and they have a whole big room full of babies, and you pick the one you want, and you buy it and take it home.
BENJAMIN: *(Skeptical.)* Really?
CASSIE: Yeah… And you gotta get there early a-fore the cute ones are gone. You don't want a ugly baby.
BENJAMIN: Are the cute ones more 'spensive?
CASSIE: No, but girls cost more than boys 'cause they're sweeter.
BENJAMIN: That's stupid.
CASSIE: *(Shocked.)* Um! You said a bad word! Daddy says I'm not pa-spost to say that.
BENJAMIN: "Stupid" isn't a bad word. It's a name.
CASSIE: Nuh-uh. *(Stage whisper on the first word only, which she thinks is a curse.)* "Stupid" isn't a NAME.
BENJAMIN: Yes, so! Daddy has a new friend named "Stupid!" Mommy says her whole name is "Stupid Widdle Hussy!"
CASSIE: Dat's a weird name.
BENJAMIN: Yeah, but not everyone can use her whole name. I called her that once during one of my daddy weekends, and boy did I get in trouble!
CASSIE: What's a daddy weekend?
BENJAMIN: Ever since my family got a da-borce, I live wif my mommy, but I get to go stay wif my daddy sometimes.
CASSIE: Oh. *(Beat.)* What's a da-borce?
BENJAMIN: It's when a mommy finds out a daddy is a… *(Matter-of-fact, as if reciting something he has been told but doesn't understand, but complete with sassy side-to-side head motions.)* …"a two-timing low-life deadbeat, and she's better off wif-out him."
CASSIE: *(Doesn't really understand either.)* Oh.
BENJAMIN: Let's pway sum-fing. Do you gots a X-Box?
CASSIE: No…
BENJAMIN: Do you gots a 'Tendo, or a Pwaystation?
CASSIE: No. My daddy says bideo games wot your bwain.
BENJAMIN: No they don't. I have a X-Box at home and my brain is good. Wait. *(BENJAMIN seems to freeze, unmoving, with a puzzled look on his face for two seconds. Suddenly, with no warning, he unleashes a single powerful sneeze.)* Choo!
CASSIE: *(Hurrying away from him in disgust.)* Eww! You're pa-spost to cover your mouth so you don't spway germs.
BENJAMIN: I don't gots germs. I just took a baff yesterday. What DO you have to play wif, a-sides coloring?
CASSIE: Um, I have Legos.
BENJAMIN: That's boring stuff.
CASSIE: *(With a shrug.)* We could play grown-up again.
BENJAMIN: *(Grudgingly.)* Ugh! Okay, but I gets to play it MY way this time. And I don't wanna hafta be married. *(Pause He crosses his arms defiantly.)* I need my freedom.
CASSIE: Okay. We can be grown-ups, but we're not mawwied.
BENJAMIN: Good.

(BENJAMIN and CASSIE both stand, resuming their grown-up voices. CASSIE extends a hand to shake.)

CASSIE (ADULT): *(Hand out.)* Hello, person I don't know. Nice to meet you. What's your name?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Shaking her hand.)* Benjamin. But you can call me Captain Awesome.
CASSIE (ADULT): Yeah, I won't be doing that. My name is Cassie. *(Walking and gesturing all around the room.)* Welcome to my house. It has a thousand rooms, and a swimming pool, and a bouncy castle, and a zoo. And I have three ponies, and their names are Rainbow, Buttercup, and Sparkles.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): That's nuffin'. *(Walking and gesturing all around the room.)* MY house has a MILLION rooms, with a real live train that goes through every room, and I always get to drive it. And it has laser tag, and a trampoline, and a race track, and a free candy store, and every video game ever. And plus, I have a pet tiger, and he eats ponies for breffest!
CASSIE (ADULT): Well, my… um… my ponies can't be eaten. They're covered with special fur that's poison to tigers, and if a tiger tries to eat them, the tiger dies instantly.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Well, I also have a T-rex, who is a-mmune to their special fur, and his name is Death To All Ponies! *(Roars his T-rex impression, complete with short arms.)*
CASSIE (ADULT): But their special fur protects them from ALL amm-inals that try to eat them.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Hmm. *(Pointing out above the audience.)* Oh no! Monsters! Giant monsters are here to eat us up!
CASSIE (ADULT): Oh no!
BENJAMIN (ADULT): And they're about to step on your ponies and SQUISH 'em! *(Grabbing a blanket or a long-sleeved jacket or sweater, he ties or holds it around his neck, quickly forming a makeshift cape.)* But it's okay, because I'm a super-hero! *(Arms in front as if flying, he runs around the room.)* I'll save us from the monsters!
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Grabbing her own blanket or jacket, and making her own cape.)* Yes! And I'm a super-hero too, so I'll save us too! Those monsters won't step on MY ponies!
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Stops running and looks at her incredulously.)* YOU can't be a super-hero.
CASSIE (ADULT): Why not?
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Duh! You're a girl.
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Hands on hips.)* EXCUSE me? For your inflammation, girls can be ANYTHING.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Name one good super-hero girl.
CASSIE (ADULT): Okay… *(Counting on her fingers.)* Wonder Woman, Supergirl, Batgirl, Bwack Widow…
BENJAMIN (ADULT): All right, so there's a FEW.
CASSIE (ADULT): *(Continues counting.)* Bwack Canary, Scarlet Witch, Inbisible Woman, Captain Marvel…
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Okay, you can stop now! How do you know so many?
CASSIE (ADULT): My daddy reads to me every night, and sometimes he reads me his old comic books. The girl heroes are the best.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): UGH! Fine. You can be a girl hero.
CASSIE (ADULT): I know. And I'm also starting my own team of super-heroes, and we're going to be called the Super-Dupers!
BENJAMIN (ADULT): Yay, okay! Who else is on our team?
CASSIE (ADULT): Oh, it's not OUR team, it's MY team. And we don't allow members who think girls can't be super-heroes. I'm sorry, but I don't think you're right for the Super-Dupers.
BENJAMIN (ADULT): *(Under his breath.)* Hmph. More like Super-POOPERS. *(Furious, crossing his arms.)* You're mean! I'm mad at you.

(BENJAMIN throws off the cape and sits down, a child again. He gives CASSIE the stink-eye death stare.)

CASSIE: *(Also a child again.)* Don't get angwy. You're pa-post to use your big boy words.
BENJAMIN: I don't wanna play any more. *(He resumes coloring.)*
CASSIE: *(Sitting with him, also a child again.)* You know, my daddy's a super-hero for real life. *(She resumes coloring as well.)*
BENJAMIN: What? No, he's not.
CASSIE: He is so, 'cause he saved me from you at the pwayground. A-member the first day we ever met? I was walking past the swings, and YOU almos' kicked me, but my daddy pulled me out of the way.
BENJAMIN: That doesn't make him a super-hero, it just makes him a daddy.

CASSIE: And then your mommy came ober, and 'pologized that you almos' kicked me, and my daddy said it was okay, and they started talking and laughing.
BENJAMIN: *(Accusatory.)* You're a-post to watch where you're going, you know. *(Changing his tone to boastful.)* I'm a good swinger.
CASSIE: Your mommy is nice. I nebber met MY mommy.
BENJAMIN: Why not?
CASSIE: She had to go away. At the hop-spital, they told us that only one of us could go home with daddy, and the other one had to go to a pwace called Heaben. Daddy says mommy let ME be the one to go home 'cause she wuvs me more than ANY-sing. But it's okay, 'cause when you move to there, they give you wings so you can fly around! *(Pretends to run and fly again.)*
BENJAMIN: Cool! I wanna move there too!
CASSIE: And also, I sink they have big spy cameras there, 'cause daddy says mommy is still watching me from Heaben, even though it's so far away.
BENJAMIN: *(Mind blown.)* Whoa. Can she see us right now?
CASSIE: I sink so.

(BENJAMIN and CASSIE both look upwards and all around the room, searching for cameras.)

BENJAMIN: I wanna be a spy when I'm growed up.
CASSIE: I want to be a powice ossifer, or maybe a amm-inal doctor.
BENJAMIN: But I still wanna play and have fun and stuff. Growed-ups are boring, and they do weird stuff 'stead of fun stuff.
CASSIE: Like what?
BENJAMIN: Like on my daddy weekends, daddy and Stupid are always kissing and hugging and gross stuff like that. Yuck.
CASSIE: Y'know, MY daddy and YOUR mommy do kissing stuff, too.
BENJAMIN: *(Disgusted.)* Eww! No they don't!
CASSIE: Yes they do. I seen 'em. It's how come they're making us do a pwaydate, so they can kiss and stuff.
BENJAMIN: Nuh-uh. We're having a playdate so they can do chores.
CASSIE: Chores?
BENJAMIN: Yeah, 'cause I heard my mommy talking to my Aunt Becky on the phone about it, and mommy said it was goin' good and pretty soon, they were finally gonna sweep togever.
CASSIE: *(Disgusted.)* Bluck! Eww. I hate chores.
BENJAMIN: Me, too.
CASSIE: But I sink it's okay when people do kissy stuff. It means they wike each other.
BENJAMIN: Eww! No, it's NOT okay! Their mouths touch, and that's a-zactly how you get cooties.
CASSIE: Cooties aren't weal.
BENJAMIN: YES, HUH! You don't even believe in cooties?
CASSIE: Daddy took me to the doctor once, and the doctor said I hafta worry about "germs" an' "buck-teria," but not cooties.
BENJAMIN: You're so weird. I don't fink I wanna play any more. I'm gonna tell mommy I wanna leave. *(He stands.)*
CASSIE: *(Cautionary tone.)* We're not pa-spost to bother 'em 'less it's a 'mergency.
BENJAMIN: This IS a ma-mergency. You're WEIRD, and it's freaking me out. I'm gonna go talk to mommy. *(Starts to walk towards SL.)* Mommy!
CASSIE: *(Knowingly.)* Okay. I warned you.

(BENJAMIN exits SL, leaving CASSIE alone to color. After a few seconds, he runs back onstage, eyes wide as if he just saw something horrific offstage that has traumatized him forever. He is screaming and running non-stop towards SR.)

BENJAMIN: *(Screaming as he runs, not even looking at her.)* Eeeeewwwwww!!! I don't wanna play any more!!!

(BENJAMIN exits SR as fast as he can. CASSIE shrugs and goes back to coloring. Lights out.)

THE END